

Automate Cybersecurity Tasks with Python ×

Module 1 ▼ Introduction to Python

Module 2 ▼ Write effective Python code

Module 3 ▼ Work with strings and lists

Module 4 ▲ Python in practice

Python for automation

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Video • 1 min
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- ✓ Test your knowledge: Python and automation
Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%

Work with files in Python

Work with files in Python

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You previously explored how to open files in Python as well as how to read them and write to them. You also examined how to adjust the structure of file contents through the `.split()` method. In this reading, you'll review the `.split()` method, and you'll also learn an additional method that can help you work with file contents.

Parsing

Part of working with files involves structuring its contents to meet your needs. **Parsing** is the process of converting data into a more readable format. Data may need to become more readable in a couple of different ways. First, certain parts of your Python code may require modification into a specific format. By converting data into this format, you enable Python to process it in a specific way. Second, programmers need to read and interpret the results of their code, and parsing can also make the data more readable for them.

Methods that can help you parse your data include `.split()` and `.join()`.

.split()

The basics of .split()

The `.split()` method converts a string into a list. It separates the string based on a specified character that's passed into `.split()` as an argument.

In the following example, the usernames in the `approved_users` string are separated by a comma. For this

